



University of Mumbai

Guidelines for On-the-Job Training (OJT) for Post Graduate Students As per NEP 2020

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1. Introduction:

With the introduction of NEP 2020, the higher education programs in India are gearing up to combine theoretical learning with practical application. On-the-job training and internships are tools that provide students with opportunities to apply theoretical knowledge in real-world settings. This hands-on experience helps bridge the gap between classroom learning and practical application.

Internships and on-the-job training programs also offer students the chance to develop essential skills that employers highly value. These include communication skills, problem-solving abilities, teamwork, and adaptability. By working in a professional environment, students gain valuable experience that enhances their employability. They also learn to navigate professional environments, manage responsibilities, and overcome challenges. This experiential learning fosters independence, confidence, and self-awareness, which are essential for success in both career and life.

Furthermore, students get a first-hand look at various industries and career paths. This exposure allows them to explore different fields, understand industry trends, and identify areas of interest. It also helps students make more informed decisions about their career paths after graduation. At the same time, students get valuable networking opportunities. They interact with professionals in their field, build relationships, and expand their professional network. These connections can benefit future job opportunities, mentorship, and career guidance.

Experience gained through internships/ on-the-job training certainly adds value to students' resumes. Employers often look for candidates with practical experience; internships give students a competitive edge in the job market. In addition, a successful internship can sometimes lead to full-time employment opportunities with the same organization.

It is with this backdrop that the University of Mumbai has crafted its OJT policy in light of the NEP 2020 framework as well as the guidelines provided by the Higher and Technical Education Department, Government of Maharashtra (2024) and **UGC Guidelines for Internship/Research Internship for Undergraduate Students 2023**.

An Internship/OJT programme aims to provide students or recent graduates with practical

work experience related to their field of study or career interests. Internships may focus on skill development, career exploration, or both.

According to the UGC guidelines, in an internship programme, students are required to participate in work experience or professional activity, or cooperative education activity with an entity external to the education institution, under the supervision of an expert from the given external entity. A prime aspect of the internship is induction into actual work situations. Internships and OJTs include working with government or private organizations, educational institutions, research and development labs/research organizations/non- government organizations, enterprises, centres involved in research, innovativeness and entrepreneurship, business organizations, local industry, artists, craftspeople, farmers- producer organizations and similar other entities for providing opportunities to students for active engagement in on-site experiential learning.

On-the-job training (OJT) is a practical approach to acquiring new competencies and skills needed for a job in a real, or close to real, working environment. It provides the trainees with opportunities to practice skills and apply their knowledge under the most realistic conditions possible, which are the actual job conditions.

2. OJT Objectives:

An OJT programme in general sets out to achieve objectives such as

1. Align classroom learnings with workplace outcomes.
2. Provide students with real-world work experience and align their expectations with job demands.
3. Combine physical and digital learning modes in industry settings, blended with mentorship.
4. Foster research skills, including knowledge discovery, analytical tools, methodologies, and ethical conduct.
5. Introduce students to emerging technologies and their applications in various fields.
6. Strengthen students' entrepreneurial skills and encourage job creation.

7. Facilitate problem-solving, decision-making, teamwork, and collaboration.
8. Foster social awareness and philanthropic values among students.
9. Encourage collaboration between Higher Education Institutes (HEIs), industry, and academia for internships and research opportunities.
10. Instill professional principles, ethics, values, and integrity to meet employment market demands and social needs.

3. OJT outcomes:

After the completion of the OJT programme, the student will be able to;

- apply concepts learned in classrooms to real-world work environments, enhancing their understanding and skills.
- show insights into the challenges, opportunities, and culture of different workplaces, preparing them for future employment.
- navigate through various learning modalities effectively through exposure to hybrid learning models.
- show evidence of research aptitude and skills of critical thinking, analytical skills, and ethical research conduct in the conduct, and communication of their work
- use and appreciate the use of emerging technologies and their applications, enhancing their technological literacy and adaptability.
- display problem-solving abilities in making informed decisions in complex scenarios through practical situations.
- work in teams and collaborate to achieve common goals in diverse work environments through collaborative projects.
- give examples and cite ways of contributing to the field of work in a manner that displays social responsibility and sustainability.

- display integrity in their dealings with their work and the people that they interact
-

with by upholding professional; principles and ethical standards.

4. An indicative list of areas for OJT:

- Trade and Agriculture
- Economy & Banking Financial Services and Insurance
- Logistics, Automotive & Capital Goods
- Fast Moving Consumer Goods & Retail
- Information Technology/Information Technology Enabled Services & Electronics
- Handcraft, Art, Design & Music
- Healthcare & Life Science
- Sports, Wellness and Physical Education
- Tourism & Hospitality
- Digitization & Emerging Technologies (Internet of Things/Artificial
- Intelligence/Machine Learning/Deep Learning/Augmented Reality/Virtual Reality etc.)
- Humanitarian, Public Policy and Legal Services
- Communication
- Education
- Sustainable Development
- Environment
- Commerce, Medium and Small-Scale Industries

It may please be noted: This is only an indicative list and not an exhaustive one.

5. Credits and Duration of On-the-Job Training (OJT):

- a) On-the-job training (OJT) will carry a weightage of Four Credits.
- b) Each student is required to complete one hundred and twenty clock hours of On-the-Job Training (OJT)⁷.
- c) The OJT program is to be completed during Semester II. According to the guidelines outlined in the National Education Policy (NEP), postgraduate students are expected to fulfil this requirement either within the second semester of their PG program or during the semester break following the second semester⁸.

6. Evaluation of OJT:

Evaluation during the OJT program involves two key components: External Evaluation (50%) and Internal Evaluation (50%). The following is a suggested two-fold pattern of

evaluation.

1. Host Organization Evaluation: The host organization will assess students based on criteria such as punctuality, completion of hours, and proficiency in required skill sets. They will also provide feedback on the student's overall performance.
2. Department Mentor Evaluation: Additionally, students will be evaluated by their department mentor based on their weekly reporting, written report, and viva voce/presentations.

Appendices

Appendix I: OJT Undertaking

1. Student Name:	
2. Current Address	
3. Residence Address	
4. Email ID	
5. Mobile No.	
6. Aadhar	
7. PAN	
8. Overall GPA	
9. Mode of Internship	
confirm that I agree with the terms, conditions, and requirements of the OJT Policy	
Student	
Signature:	
Date	
I confirm that the student has attended the OJT orientation, and he/she has met all paperwork and process requirements to participate in the OJT programme and has received approval from his/her mentor.	
Sign of Head of the Department/ Department Coordinator/Mentor	
Date	

Appendix IV: Joining Letter of student

< College/Department/Centre/Institute >

To

(Designation of Person addressed)

.....

.....

Subject: Joining letter of student

Dear Sir,

Kindly refer to your letter/e-mail dated _____ on the above-cited subject. As permitted by your good self the following students will undergo OJT/ Internship in your esteemed organization under your sole guidance and direction

Sr. No.	Name	Roll no.	Year	Department

This training is an essential part of the curriculum, and the following guidelines have been prescribed in the curriculum for the training. You are, therefore, requested to please issue the following guidelines to the concerned OJT supervisor.

- Each student is required to prepare an OJT diary and report.
- Kindly check the OJT diary of the student on a timely manner.
- Issue instructions regarding working hours during training and maintenance of the attendance record

You are requested to evaluate the student's performance based on the below-mentioned parameters (we will provide you with the evaluation sheet):

Completion of Hours	Quality/Performance	Punctuality/Regularity
---------------------	---------------------	------------------------

The performance report may please be forwarded to the undersigned on completion of training in a sealed envelope or in an email.

Your efforts in this regard will positively enhance the knowledge and practical skills of the students, your cooperation will be highly appreciated, and we shall feel obliged.

The students will abide by the rules and regulations of the organization and will maintain proper discipline with keen interest during their OJT. The students will report to you on

_____ (date) along with a copy of this letter.

Yours sincerely,

Internship Coordinator/HoD

<Department Name and Date>

Appendix V: Student Diary (Log) Recording Format

Week	Task Assigned	Activities Performed	Key Learnings	Additional Remarks

Signature of Industry/organization Supervisor

Appendix VI: Attendance Sheet¹⁰

<Organization Letter Head>

Name & Address of organization

Name of the Student	
Roll Number	
Name of Course	
Date of Commencement of Training	
Date of Completion of Training	

Month and Year:

Week	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						
11						
12						

- The attendance sheet should remain affixed to the Daily Training Diary. Do not remove or tear it off.
- Holidays should be marked in Red Ink in the attendance column. Absent should be marked as 'A' in Red Ink.

Name and Signature of OJT Supervisor (with date)_____

¹⁰ Even in case of hybrid mode, a certificate of attendance duly signed by the OJT Supervisor needs to be submitted.

Appendix VII: Supervisor Evaluation of OJT Student¹¹

<Organization Letter Head>

Student Name: _____ Date: _____

OJT Supervisor: _____ Title: _____

Organization: _____

OJT Address: _____

Dates of OJT: From _____ To _____

Please evaluate the intern based on the points mentioned in the table below.

S.no.	Particular	Marks
1	Completing of Hours (out of 20)	
2	Quality/Performance (out of 20)	
3	Punctuality/Regularity (out of 10)	
Total (out of 50)		

Overall performance of student intern (circle one): (Needs improvement / Satisfactory / Good / Excellent)

Additional comments, if any:

Signature of Industry/organization supervisor _____

¹¹ Please note that this is a suggested template. However, the department may modify as per their parameters

Appendix IX: Proforma for OJT COMPLETION CERTIFICATE

The student should attach OJT completion certificate, duly signed by the industry/organization supervisor to his/her report. A representative format for the OJT completion certificate is as given below:

CERTIFICATE

(On Company/Institute Letterhead)

This is to certify that Ms./Mr. _____, has successfully completed the On-Job training in the _____, from _____ to _____ under the supervision of _____

Authorized signature

Appendix X – Format of OJT Report

- Title of the Report: On-the-Job Training Experience Report
- Name of the Student:
- Name of the organization:
- Department/Division Where Training took place
- Duration of Training: [Start Date to End Date of Training]
- Date of Submission: [Date of Submitting the Report]

The following is a suggested outline. However, the students are advised to consult their respective OJT Mentors.

- Introduction
- Company Overview
- Training Objectives
- Training Experience
- Skills Developed
- Achievements & Contributions
- Challenges Faced
- Lessons Learned
- Recommendations
- Conclusion
- Appendices (if any)
- References

Appendix XI: Student Feedback of OJT¹²

(To be filled by Students after OJT completion)

Student Name: _____ Date: _____

Industry/Organization Supervisor: _____ Title: _____

Supervisor Email: _____ OJT is: _Paid_____ _Unpaid_____

Organization: _____

OJT Address: _____

Faculty Coordinator: _____ Department: _____

Dates of OJT: From _____ To _____

Give a brief description of your OJT work (title and tasks for which you were responsible): Was your internship experience related to your major area of study?

- Yes, to a large degree
- Yes, to a slight degree
- No, not related at all

Indicate the degree to which you agree or disagree with the following statements.

This experience has:	Strongly Agree	Agree	No opinion	Disagree	Strongly Disagree
Given me the opportunity to explore a career field					
Allowed me to apply classroom theory to practice					
Helped me develop my decision-making and problem-solving skills					
Expanded my knowledge about the work world before permanent employment					
Helped me develop my written and oral communication skills					
Provided a chance to use leadership skills (influence others, develop ideas with others, stimulate decision-making and action)					

¹² The College/Department/Centre may generate the form using Google Form.

Expanded my sensitivity to the ethical implications of the work Involved					
Made it possible for me to be more confident in new situations					
Given me a chance to improve my interpersonal skills					
Helped me learn to handle responsibility and use my time wisely					
Helped me discover new aspects of myself that I didn't know existed before					
Helped me develop new interests and abilities					
Helped me clarify my career Goals					
Provided me with contacts which may lead to future employment					
Allowed me to acquire information and/ or use equipment not available at my Institute					

- In the Institute OJT program, faculty members are expected to be mentors for students. Do you feel that your faculty coordinator served such a function? Why or why not?
- How well were you able to accomplish the initial goals, tasks and new skills that were set down in your learning contract? In what ways were you able to take a new direction or expand beyond your contract? Why were some goals not accomplished adequately?

- In what areas did you most develop and improve?
- What has been the most significant accomplishment or satisfying moment of your OJT?
- What did you dislike about the OJT?
- Considering your overall experience, how would you rate this OJT? (Circle one).
-Satisfactory/ Good/ Excellent
- Give suggestions as to how your OJT experience could have been improved. (Could you have handled added responsibility? Would you have liked more discussions with your professor concerning your OJT? Was closer supervision needed? Was more of an orientation required?)

<Signature of Student>

<Name, Roll number, Date>

Under the Guidance of

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OJT Guidelines Draft Committee

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